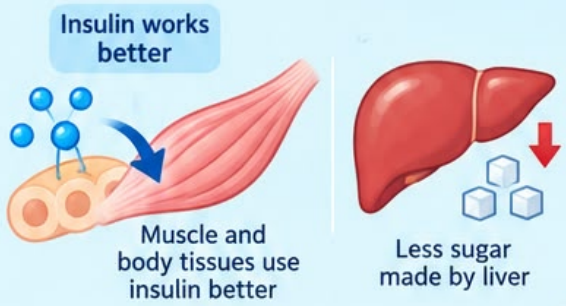
# Pioglitazone

## Helps lower your blood sugar

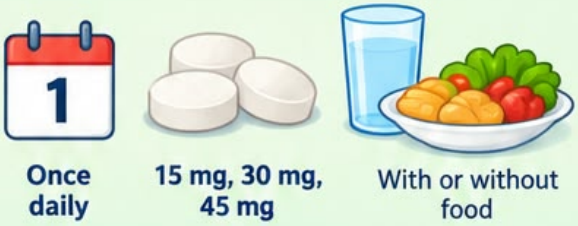
## What does it do?

- Makes your body more sensitive to insulin.
- Helps your muscles and other tissues use insulin better.
- Reduces the amount of sugar made by your liver.



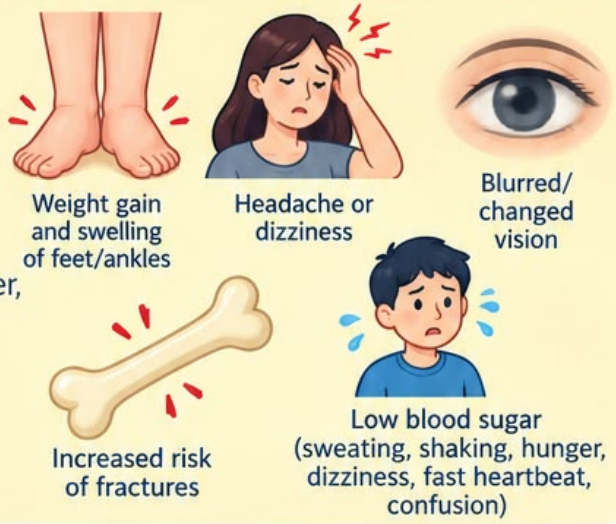

## How should I take it?

- Usually taken once daily, with or without food.
- Take exactly as prescribed by your doctor.
- Common tablet strengths are 15 mg, 30 mg and 45 mg.




## Common side effects

- Weight gain and swelling of feet/ankles.
- Headache or dizziness.
- Blurred/changed vision.
- Increased risk of fractures.
- Low blood sugar — sweating, shaking, hunger, dizziness, fast heartbeat, confusion.




## If you have low blood sugar

If you feel shaky, sweaty, dizzy, or weak, your blood sugar may be low. Take something sugary immediately, such as ½ glass of fruit juice or 3 teaspoons of sugar dissolved in water. Wait 15 minutes and check your blood sugar again, if possible. If you still feel unwell, take the same amount again.



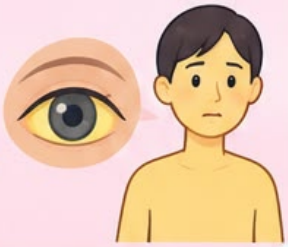

## Important warning



Shortness of breath or rapid weight gain — **seek medical attention immediately.**



Report blood in urine, painful urination, or yellowing of skin/eyes to your doctor.





**Do not stop pioglitazone without consulting your doctor or pharmacist.**